

WEIJIAN LAO

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Last updated: October 1, 2026

Education

- **Nanyang Technological University (NTU)**
Visiting Research Student 2026
- **Southwestern University of Finance and Economics (SWUFE)**
Ph.D. Candidate in Regional Economics 2022 – 2027 Expected
- **Southwestern University of Finance and Economics (SWUFE)**
M.A. in Industrial Economics 2019 – 2022
- **Hangzhou Dianzi University Information Engineering School**
B.A. in Information Management and Information Systems 2013 – 2017

Research Interests

Development Economics, Urban Economics and Environmental Economics

Publications

1. **Does Digital Finance Development Promote Household Charitable Giving?** with Zhengwei Yan, Lei Han, and Sean Song, *China Journal of Economics* (经济学报), 2025, 12(01): 77–95.
2. **Clan Culture and E-commerce Development**, with Jiancheng Wang and Fang Qin, *The Journal of World Economy* (世界经济), 2026, 49(1): 111–142.

Working Papers

1. **Beyond Compensation: Persistent Income Gains from Land Expropriation in Rural China**
2. **Land Titling, Gender, and Labor Mobility**, with Xiling Lei and Shukang Xiao
3. **Precipitation Extremes, Rural Livelihoods, and Fertility in China**, with Xiling Lei
4. **Bricks and Beliefs: The Political Consequences of Booming House Prices in China**, with Shilong Zhuang

Selected Work in Progress

1. **Dams and Human Capital**
2. **Water Infrastructure and Firm Performance**
3. **Political Centralization and Village Governance**

Academic Research Projects

1. “Clan Culture and the Elderly Health: Evidence from China,” the Fundamental Research Funds for the Central Universities (No. JBK2307080; RMB 10,000), 2023–2024. *Principal Investigator*. Completed.
2. “Theoretical Modeling and Policy Effect Evaluation of Administrative Boundary Adjustments under New Urbanization,” NSFC General Program (No. 72373121), 2024–2027. *Par-*

ticipant. Ongoing.

3. “Development Dilemmas and Transformation Pathways in Population-Declining Regions,” MOE Humanities & Social Sciences Project (No. 24YJC790117), 2024–. *Participant*. Ongoing.

Teaching Assistant

- Urban Economics, SWUFE Fall 2022
- Econometrics, SWUFE Spring 2023
- Probability Theory, SWUFE Fall 2023

Academic Activities

Presentations

- 2025: Chinese Economists Society (CES) China Annual Conference
- 2025: YES × Chengdu: Theory, Policy and High-Quality Development Symposium
- 2023: 24th Hong Kong Sociological Association Annual Conference

Research Experience

- County Gazetteer Data Collection and Construction, RA 2022 – present
- Xiangzhang Western Program, TA 2024

Skills

- **Software:** Stata, Python, ArcGIS, R, $\text{\LaTeX}$
- **Language:** Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)